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INDIA'S CHARGES



- India said evidence gathered points clearly to the territory of Pakistan as a source of the Mumbai attacks
- That key operatives including Zakir-ur Lakhvi of the Lashkar-e-Toiba was involved
- Had given details of the movement of 10 terrorists from Karachi to Mumbai
- Provided evidence to show that during the attack terrorists were directed by handlers based in Pakistan
- Had suggested that state actors in Pakistan like the ISI were involved

PAKISTAN'S ADMISSIONS



- Pakistan acknowledges that 'some part of the conspiracy' was planned on its soil
- Names nine new accused and admits that some of them have links with Lashkar
- Says it has seized one of the boats used in Pakistan and arrested its owner
- Expanded the list to include suspects in Austria, Italy, Spain, US, Russia and a Gulf country
- Omits mention of any involvement of Pakistan state agencies in 26/11



BY ASKING ABOUT AN INDIAN CONNECTION TO 26/11, PAKISTAN IS EXPLOITING THE CONTROVERSY RAISED BY NARENDRA MODI OVER THE ISSUE.



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Pakistan asked India 30 additional questions that included the confessional statements of Ajmal Amir Kasab, the only Mumbai attacker to be apprehended alive, apart from samples of his DNA. In a clever twist, among the questions that Pakistan wanted answered by India was how SIM cards used by the attackers were purchased in India and also whether an Indian was involved in the 26/11 attack. It seeks to exploit the controversy raised by Gujarat Chief Minister Narendra Modi who had talked of

Indian links in the attacks and Home Minister P. Chidambaram retorting that Modi seems "in contact" with Pakistan. In another surprising finding, Pakistan said one of the terrorists involved in the 2006 Samjhauta Express attack was also involved in carrying out the Mumbai strikes. Both of these statements would require a thorough investigation by India.

For the UPA-led Government, which had come under attack from the Opposition for fumbling in its response to Pakistan after the Mumbai

attacks, Islamabad's replies have brought it some comfort and time too. While it termed Pakistan's response as "a positive development" it was evident that it had fallen short on several fronts. The Indian Government would now have to mount fresh pressure on Pakistan on its main demands that the masterminds of the Mumbai attacks be extradited to India to stand trial and also that Pakistan should make all efforts to dismantle the terror infrastructure and prevent future attacks. The fight has just begun. ■